

Start here.

Nine pages for the dog you already have. The records and the numbers, the walk and what it is actually for, food weighed rather than guessed and a year of weights, the words the whole house agrees to use, the weekly hands-on check, the page you leave for the sitter, and somewhere to write down the small things.

1 WHAT IS IN YOUR DOWNLOAD

4 fillable kits	Letter + A4 · colour + ink-saving mono · 9 pages each
4 print kits	the same pages without form fields
Print page 2 first	the numbers, on the fridge, before you need them
This guide	printing and filling in, on one page

2 TYPE ON IT

Open a file ending in **-fillable.pdf** in Adobe Acrobat Reader (free) or a tablet app and type. Tick the boxes with a click. **Save a copy per dog** — pages 1 to 7 are about one animal, and a second dog wants its own file rather than a shared one.

3 OR PRINT AND WRITE

The **-print.pdf** files are the same nine pages without fields. Three of them are meant to leave the folder: **page 2** goes on the fridge with the out-of-hours number filled in, **page 6** goes up where the family will read it so everyone uses the same words, and **page 8** gets left out for whoever has the dog while you are away.

4 PRINT IT WELL

- Paper: plain A4 or US Letter, 90-120 gsm
- Scale: **100% / Actual size** — never “Fit to page”
- One copy of pages 1-7 per dog; pages 8 and 9 can be shared
- Saving ink? The **mono** kit is the same layout in graphite only

5 WHAT THIS IS, AND WHAT IT IS NOT

It is a **record book**, made by a designer. It is not veterinary advice, not a diagnosis, not a training course, and not a substitute for phoning your practice. The signs listed on page 2 are the short version of what emergency vets ask people to come in for — they are not complete, and a dog that seems wrong to you is reason enough to call. Fill in the out-of-hours number **today**, while nothing is happening: it is usually a different practice from your own, and the moment you need it is the moment you cannot look it up.